# The Sumerian king list -- an English prose translation

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Paragraph labels = ETCSL composite line ranges covered by each translation paragraph. "..." = untranslatable/lost text.

**1-39.** After the kingship descended from heaven, the kingship was in Eridug. In Eridug, Alulim became king; he ruled for 28800 years. Alalĝar ruled for 36000 years. 2 kings; they ruled for 64800 years. Then Eridug fell and the kingship was taken to Bad-tibira. In Bad-tibira, En-men-lu-ana ruled for 43200 years. En-men-gal-ana ruled for 28800 years. Dumuzid, the shepherd, ruled for 36000 years. 3 kings; they ruled for 108000 years. Then Bad-tibira fell (?) and the kingship was taken to Larag. In Larag, En-sipad-zid-ana ruled for 28800 years. 1 king; he ruled for 28800 years. Then Larag fell (?) and the kingship was taken to Zimbir. In Zimbir, En-men-dur-ana became king; he ruled for 21000 years. 1 king; he ruled for 21000 years. Then Zimbir fell (?) and the kingship was taken to Šuruppag. In Šuruppag, Ubara-Tutu became king; he ruled for 18600 years. 1 king; he ruled for 18600 years. In 5 cities 8 kings; they ruled for 241200 years. Then the flood swept over.

**40-94.** After the flood had swept over, and the kingship had descended from heaven, the kingship was in Kiš. In Kiš, Ĝušur became king; he ruled for 1200 years. Kullassina-bēl ruled for 960 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 900 years. Nanĝišlišma ruled for [note: ms. P2+L2 has:] 670 (?) years. En-taraḫ-ana ruled for [note: ms. P2+L2 has:] 420 years ....., 3 months, and 3 1/2 days. Babum ..... ruled for [note: ms. P2+L2 has:] 300 years. Puannum ruled for 840 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 240 years. Kalibum ruled for 960 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 900 years. Kalūmum ruled for 840 [note: mss. P3+BT14, Su1 have instead:] 900 years. Zuqāqīp ruled for 900 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 600 years. [note: in mss. P2+L2, P3+BT14, P5, the 10th and 11th rulers of the dynasty precede the 8th and 9th] Atab [note: mss. P2+L2, P3+BT14, P5 have instead:] A-ba ruled for 600 years. Mašda, the son of Atab, ruled for 840 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 720 years. Arwium, the son of Mašda, ruled for 720 years. Etana, the shepherd, who ascended to heaven and consolidated all the foreign countries, became king; he ruled for 1500 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 635 years. Baliḫ, the son of Etana, ruled for 400 [note: mss. P2+L2, Su1 have instead:] 410 years. En-me-nuna ruled for 660 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 621 years. Melem-Kiš, the son of En-me-nuna, ruled for 900 years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 1560 are the years of the dynasty of En-me-nuna. Barsal-nuna, the son of En-me-nuna, [note: mss. P5, P3+BT14 have instead:] Barsal-nuna ruled for 1200 years. Zamug, the son of Barsal-

nuna, ruled for 140 years. Tizqār, the son of Zamug, ruled for 305 years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 1620 + X ..... Ilku ruled for 900 years. Iltasadum ruled for 1200 years. En-me-barage-si, who made the land of Elam submit, became king; he ruled for 900 years. Aga, the son of En-me-barage-si, ruled for 625 years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 1525 are the years of the dynasty of En-me-barage-si. 23 kings; they ruled for 24510 years, 3 months, and 3 1/2 days. Then Kiš was defeated and the kingship was taken to E-ana.

**95-133.** In E-ana, Meš-ki-aĝ-gašer, the son of Utu, became lord and king; he ruled for 324 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 325 years. Meš-ki-aĝ-gašer entered the sea and disappeared. Enmerkar, the son of Meš-ki-aĝ-gašer, the king of Unug, who built Unug [note: mss. L1+N1, P2+L2 have instead:] under whom Unug was built , became king; he ruled for 420 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 900 + X years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 745 are the years of the dynasty of Meš-ki-aĝ-gašer. [note: ms TL adds instead:] .....; he ruled for 5 + X years. Lugalbanda, the shepherd, ruled for 1200 years. Dumuzid, the fisherman whose city was Kuara, ruled for 100 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 110 years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] He captured En-me-barage-si single-handed. Gilgameš, whose father was a phantom (?), the lord of Kulaba, ruled for 126 years. Ur-Nungal, the son of Gilgameš, ruled for 30 years. Udul-kalama, the son of Ur-Nungal [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] Ur-lugal , ruled for 15 years. Lā-baʾšum ruled for 9 years. En-nun-taraḫ-ana ruled for 8 years. Meš-ḫe, the smith, ruled for 36 years. Melem-ana [note: ms. Su2 has instead:] Til-kug (?) ..... ruled for 6 [note: ms. Su2 has instead:] 900 years. Lugal-kitun (?) ruled for 36 [note: ms. Su2 has instead:] 420 years. 12 kings; they ruled for 2310 [note: ms. Su2 has instead:] 3588 years. Then Unug was defeated and the kingship was taken to Urim.

**134-147.** In Urim, Meš-Ane-pada became king; he ruled for 80 years. Meš-ki-aĝ-Nanna [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] Meš-ki-aĝ-nuna , the son of Meš-Ane-pada, became king; he ruled for 36 [note: ms. P2+L2 has instead:] 30 years. Elulu ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, P2+L2, P3+BT14 have:] 25 years. Balulu ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, P2+L2, P3+BT14 have:] 36 years. [note: mss. L1+N1, P2+L2 have:] 4 kings; they ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, P2+L2, P3+BT14 have:] 171 years. Then Urim was defeated and the kingship was taken to Awan.

**148-159.** In Awan, ..... became king; he ruled for ..... years. ..... ruled for ..... years. ..... ruled for 36 years. 3 kings; they ruled for 356 years. Then Awan was defeated and the kingship was taken to Kiš.

**160-178.** In Kiš, Susuda, the fuller, became king; he ruled for 201 + X years. Dadasig ruled for [note: ms. vD has:] 81 years. Mamagal, the boatman, ruled for 360 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 420 years. Kalbum, the son of Mamagal [note: ms. WB has instead:] Magalgal , ruled for 195 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 132 years. Tuge (?) ruled for 360 years. Men-nuna , [note: ms. L1+N1 adds:] the son of Tuge (?), ruled for 180 years. [note: in mss. L1+N1, TL, the 7th and

8th rulers of the dynasty are in reverse order] ..... ruled for 290 years. Lugalĝu ruled for 360 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 420 years. 8 kings; they ruled for 3195 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 3792 years. Then Kiš was defeated and the kingship was taken to Ḫamazi.

**179-185.** In Ḫamazi, Hadaniš became king; he ruled for 360 years. 1 king; he ruled for 360 years. Then Ḫamazi was defeated and the kingship was taken [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] was returned a second time to Unug.

**186-192.** In Unug, En-šag-kuš-ana became king; he ruled for 60 years. Lugal-ure [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] Lugal-kiniše-dudu (?) ruled for 120 years. Argandea ruled for 7 years. [note: ms. L1+N1 has:] 3 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. L1+N1 has:] 187 years. Then Unug was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Urim.

**193-204.** In Urim, Nanni became king; he ruled for [note: ms. vD has:] 120 + X [note: ms. IB has instead:] 54 + X years. Meš-ki-aĝ-Nanna, the son of Nanni, ruled for [note: ms. vD has:] 48 years. ....., the son (?) of ....., ruled for [note: ms. IB has:] 2 years. [note: ms. IB has:] 3 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. IB has:] 582 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 578 years. [note: ms. vD has instead:] 2 kings; they ruled for 120 + X years. Then Urim was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Adab.

**205-210.** In Adab, Lugal-Ane-mundu became king; he ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, TL have:] 90 years. [note: mss. L1+N1, TL have:] 1 king; he ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, TL have:] 90 years. Then Adab was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Mari.

**211-223.** In Mari, Anbu (?) became king; he ruled for 30 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 90 years. Anba (?), the son of Anbu (?), ruled for 17 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 7 years. Bazi, the leatherworker, ruled for 30 years. Zizi, the fuller, ruled for 20 years. Limer, the *gudug* priest, ruled for 30 years. Šarrum-īter ruled for 9 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 7 years. 6 kings; they ruled for 136 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 184 years. Then Mari was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Kiš.

**224-231.** In Kiš, Kug-Bau, the woman tavern-keeper, who made firm the foundations of Kiš, became king; she ruled for 100 years. 1 king; she ruled for 100 years. Then Kiš was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Akšak.

**232-243.** In Akšak, Unzi became king; he ruled for 30 years. Undalulu ruled for 6 [note: mss. L1+N1, S have instead:] 12 years. Urur ruled for [note: ms. IB has instead:] was king (?) for 6 years. Puzur-Niraḫ ruled for [note: mss. IB, L1+N1, S, Su1 have:] 20 years. Išu-Il ruled for [note: mss. IB, L1+N1, S, Su1 have:] 24 years. Šu-Suen, the son of Išu-Il, ruled for [note: mss. IB, L1+N1, S, TL have:] 7 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 24 years. [note: mss. S, Su1, TL have:] 6 kings; they ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, S, TL have:] 99 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 116 years [note: ms. IB

has instead:] 5 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. IB has:] 87 years . Then Akšak was defeated [note: ms. S has instead:] Then the reign of Akšak was abolished and the kingship was taken to Kiš.

**244-258.** In Kiš, Puzur-Suen, the son of Kug-Bau, became king; he ruled for 25 years. Ur-Zababa, the son of Puzur-Suen, ruled for 400 [note: mss. P3+BT14, S have instead:] 6 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 4 + X years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 131 are the years of the dynasty of Kug-Bau. Zimudar [note: ms. TL has instead:] Ziĝu-iake ruled for 30 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 30 + X years. Usi-watar, the son of Zimudar [note: ms. TL has instead:] Ziĝu-iake , ruled for 7 [note: ms. S has instead:] 6 years. Eštar-muti ruled for 11 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 17 (?) years. Išme-Šamaš ruled for 11 years. [note: ms. Su1 adds:] Šu-ilīšu ruled for 15 years. Nanniya, the jeweller, [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] Zimudar [note: ms. IB has instead:] ..... ruled for 7 [note: ms. S has instead:] 3 years. 7 kings; they ruled for 491 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 485 years [note: ms. S has instead:] 8 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. S has:] 586 years . Then Kiš was defeated [note: ms. S has instead:] Then the reign of Kiš was abolished and the kingship was taken [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] was returned a third time to Unug.

**259-265.** In Unug, Lugal-zage-si became king; he ruled for 25 [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] 34 years. 1 king; he ruled for 25 [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] 34 years. Then Unug was defeated [note: ms. S has instead:] Then the reign of Unug was abolished and the kingship was taken to Agade.

**266-296.** In Agade, Sargon, whose father was a gardener, the cupbearer of Ur-Zababa, became king, the king of Agade, who built Agade [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] under whom Agade was built ; he ruled for 56 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 55 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 54 years. Rīmuš, the son of Sargon, ruled for 9 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 7 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 15 years. Man-ištiššu, the older brother of Rīmuš, the son of Sargon, ruled for 15 [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] 7 years. Narām-Suen, the son of Man-ištiššu, ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, P3+BT14 have:] 56 years. Šar-kali-šarrī, the son of Narām-Suen, ruled for [note: ms. L1+N1, Su+Su4 have:] 25 [note: ms. P3+BT14 has instead:] 24 years. [note: ms. P3+BT14 adds:] 157 are the years of the dynasty of Sargon. Then who was the king? Who was not the king? [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] who was the king? Who indeed was the king? Irgigi was king, Imi was king, Nanûm was king [note: in mss. L1+N1, Su3+Su4, Imi and Nanûm are in reverse order] , Ilulu was king, and the [note: mss. P3+BT14, S have:] 4 of them ruled for only [note: mss. P3+BT14, S have:] 3 years. Dudu ruled for 21 years. Šu-Durul, the son of Dudu, ruled for 15 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 18 years. 11 kings; they ruled for 181 years [note: ms. S has instead:] 12 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. S has:] 197 years [note: mss. Su1, Su3+Su4, which omit Dudu and Šu-Durul, have instead:] 9 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. Su1 has:] 161 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 177 years . Then Agade was defeated [note: ms. S has instead:] Then the reign of Agade was abolished and the kingship was taken to Unug.

**297-307.** In Unug, Ur-niĝin became king; he ruled for 7 [note: mss. IB, S have instead:] 3 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 15 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 30 years. Ur-gigir, the son of Ur-niĝin, ruled for 6 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 7 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 15 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 7 years. Kuda ruled for 6 years. Puzur-ilī ruled for 5 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 20 years. Ur-Utu ruled for 6 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] Ur-Utu, the son of Ur-gigir, ruled for 25 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] Lugal-melem, the son of Ur-gigir, ruled for 7 years. 5 kings; they ruled for 30 [note: ms. IB has instead:] 43 [note: mss. P4+Ha, S have instead:] 26 years [note: ms. Su3+Su4, which omits Kuda and Puzur-ilī, has instead:] 3 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has:] 47 years . Unug was defeated [note: ms. S has instead:] Then the reign of Unug was abolished and the kingship was taken to the army [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] land of Gutium.

**308-334.** In the army [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] land of Gutium, at first no king was famous; they were their own kings and ruled thus for 3 years [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] they had no king; they ruled themselves for 5 years . Then Inkišuš [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] ..... ruled for 6 [note: ms. L1+Ni1 has instead:] 7 years. Zarlagab ruled for 6 years. Šulme [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] Yarlagaš ruled for 6 years. Silulumeš [note: ms. Mi has instead:] Silulu ruled for 6 [note: ms. G has instead:] 7 years. Inimabakeš ruled for 5 [note: ms. Mi has instead:] Duga ruled for 6 years. Igešauš ruled for 6 [note: ms. Mi has instead:] Ilu-an (?) ruled for 3 years. Yarlagab ruled for 15 [note: ms. Mi has instead:] 5 years. Ibate ruled for 3 years. Yarla [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] Yarlangab (?) ruled for 3 years. Kurum [note: ms. L1+N1 has instead:] ..... ruled for 1 [note: ms. Mi has instead:] 3 years. Apilkin ruled for 3 years. Lā-erabum (?) ruled for 2 years. Irarum ruled for 2 years. Ibranum ruled for 1 year. Ḫablum ruled for 2 years. Puzur-Suen, the son of Ḫablum, ruled for 7 years. Yarlaganda ruled for 7 years. ..... ruled for 7 years. Tirigan (?) ruled for 40 days. 21 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. L1+N1 has:] 124 years and 40 days [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 25 years . Then the army of Gutium was defeated [note: ms. TL has instead:] destroyed and the kingship was taken to Unug.

**335-340.** In Unug, Utu-ḫeĝal became king; he ruled for 427 years, ..... days [note: ms. IB has instead:] 26 years, 2 + X months, and 15 days [note: ms. J has instead:] 7 years, 6 months, and 15 days [note: ms. TL has instead:] 7 years, 6 months, and 5 days . 1 king; he ruled for 427 years, ..... days [note: ms. J has instead:] 7 years, 6 months, and 15 days [note: ms. TL has instead:] 7 years, 6 months, and 5 days . Then Unug was defeated and the kingship was taken to Urim.

**341-354.** In Urim, Ur-Namma became king; he ruled for 18 years. Šulgi, the son of Ur-Namma, ruled for 46 [note: mss. Su3+Su4, TL have instead:] 48 [note: ms. P5 has instead:] 58 years. Amar-Suena, the son of Šulgi, ruled for 9 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 25 years. Šu-Suen, the son of Amar-Suena, ruled for 9 [note: ms. P5 has instead:] 7 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 20 + X [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 16 years. Ibbi-Suen, the son of Šu-Suen, ruled for 24 [note: mss. P5, Su1 have instead:] 25 [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 15 [note: ms. TL has instead:] 23 (?) years. 4 kings; they ruled for 108 years [note: mss. J, P5, Su1, Su3+Su4 have

instead:] 5 kings; they ruled for [note: ms. P5 has:] 117 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 120 + X [note: ms. Su3+Su4 has instead:] 123 years . Then Urim was defeated [note: ms. P5 has instead:] Then the reign of Urim was abolished . [note: ms. Su3+Su4 adds:] The very foundation of Sumer was torn out (?). The kingship was taken to Isin.

**355-377.** In Isin, Išbi-Erra became king; he ruled for 33 [note: ms. P5 has instead:] 32 years. Šu-ilīšu, the son of Išbi-Erra, ruled for 20 [note: ms. P5 has instead:] 10 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 15 years. Iddin-Dagan, the son of Šu-ilīšu, ruled for 21 [note: ms. Su1 has instead:] 25 years. Išme-Dagan, the son of Iddin-Dagan, ruled for [note: mss. P2, P5 have:] 20 [note: ms. Mi has instead:] 18 years. Lipit-Eštar, the son of Išme-Dagan [note: ms. P2 has instead:] Iddin-Dagan , ruled for [note: mss. L1+N1, P2, P5 have:] 11 years. Ur-Ninurta [note: mss. L1+N1, P2 add:] , the son of Iškur -- may he have years of abundance, a good reign, and a sweet life -- ruled for [note: ms. P5 has:] 28 years. Būr-Suen, the son of Ur-Ninurta, ruled for 21 years. Lipit-Enlil, the son of Būr-Suen, ruled for 5 years. Erra-imitti ruled for 8 [note: mss. P5, TL have instead:] 7 years. [note: ms. P5 adds:] ..... ruled for ..... 6 months. Enlil-bāni ruled for 24 years. Zambiya ruled for 3 years. Iter-piša ruled for 4 years. Ur-du-kuga ruled for 4 years. Suen-magir ruled for 11 years. [note: ms. P5 adds:] Damiq-ilišu, the son of Suen-magir, ruled for 23 years. 14 kings; they ruled for 203 years [note: ms. P5 has instead:] 225 years and 6 months .

**378-431.** A total of 39 kings ruled for 14409 + X years, 3 months and 3 1/2 days, 4 times in Kiš. A total of 22 kings ruled for 2610 + X years, 6 months and 15 days, 5 times in Unug. A total of 12 kings ruled for 396 years, 3 times in Urim. A total of 3 kings ruled for 356 years, once in Awan. A total of 1 king ruled for 420 years, once in Ḫamazi. *(16 lines missing)* A total of 12 (?) kings ruled for 197 (?) years, once in Agade. A total of 21 [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 23 kings ruled for 125 years and 40 days [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 99 years , once in the army of Gutium. A total of 11 [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 16 kings ruled for 159 [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 226 years, once in Isin. There are 11 cities, cities in which the kingship was exercised. A total of 134 [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 139 kings, who altogether ruled for 28876 + X [note: ms. P4+Ha has instead:] 3443 + X years. 21.